

Marking Scheme- Class X

(Pre-Board Examination 2024-25)

Subject: English Language and Literature (Code No. 184)

SECTION A: READING (20 marks)		
1.	Discursive passage	10 m
i	The phrase implies that reducing material possessions and creating a simpler environment can have a positive impact on personal health by reducing stress and enhancing mental clarity.	1
ii	a) People frequently acquire possessions that add no real value to their lives. (paragraph 1)	1
iii	The writer asserts that a tidy desk, resulting from decluttering, can enhance one's ability to focus and improve productivity, thereby aiding mental clarity and reducing distractions. (paragraph 2)	2
iv	a) A person reducing their digital media subscriptions to focus on content that aligns with their interests and values. (paragraph 4)	1
v	False. The passage emphasizes that careful planning and breaking the task into manageable steps make the decluttering process more effective. (paragraph 5)	1
vi	B. Retaining only essential items that add value to daily life. (paragraph 5)	1
vii	Reduced stress and enhanced mental clarity due to a less cluttered environment. Increased efficiency in managing daily tasks through better organization. (paragraph 2 and 4)	2
viii	C. A living space that supports emotional well-being and reduces stress.	1
2	Case-based factual passage	10 m
i	A. The writer is suggesting a sense of urgency and critical importance regarding the findings.	1
ii	B. Both the assertion and reason are true, but the reason is not the correct explanation of the assertion.	1
iii	inadequate	1
iv	Mobile clinics enhance access by traveling directly to underserved communities, providing essential health services that might otherwise be unavailable, thereby ensuring that more pregnant women receive	1

	the care they need.		
v	25% Explanation: In the provided passage, the percentage of maternal health services dedicated to prenatal education, including nutritional support, is indicated as 25%. This percentage reflects the portion of services focusing on educational aspects of maternal health, such as prenatal nutrition, within the broader context of available maternal health programs.		1
vi	It reveals that rural healthcare priorities are centered on preventing complications and ensuring early, consistent care for pregnant women.		1
vii	maintaining maternal and fetal health.		1
viii	supports the mental and emotional well-being of mothers.		1
ix	It helps identify areas where resources are lacking and allows for targeted improvements to enhance maternal health outcomes.		2
3	SECTION B: GRAMMAR (10 marks)		10*1= 10 m
Full credit 1, for correct answers. No partial credit of ½, for any question in this section.			
i	have created		1
ii	Error	Correction	1
	can	shall	
iii	Chetan asked Sneha if she worked from home.		1
iv	a		1
v	(c) in- under		1
vi	Error	Correction	1
	the	a	
vii	(c) will		1
viii	B. blew up		1
ix	A. keep asking till one does.		1
x	D. Can		1
xi	A. share		1
xii	C. why she had chosen to participate		1
	SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS (10 marks)		10 m

4	Letter	5 m
A or B	Format – 1, Content -2, Organisation of ideas -1, Accuracy 1	
	Format – 1 • full credit if all aspects included. • Partial credit (½ mark) if one-two aspects are missing. • No credit if more than two aspects are missing Content -2 2 marks : • All points included • Well-developed with sustained clarity 1½ marks: • Almost all points incorporated • Reasonably well-developed 1 mark: • Some points incorporated • Fair attempt at developing ideas with some impact on clarity of response ½ mark: • Most of the points of the given task not incorporated • Limited awareness of task development Organisation of ideas -1 • effective style, orderly sequence, paragraphed structure and formal tone and vocabulary Accuracy 1 • Spelling, punctuation and grammar	
A or B	ANALYTICAL PARAGRAPH WRITING	5 m
	Content -2, Organisation of ideas -2, Accuracy 1	
	Content -2 • All points included & well-developed with sustained clarity Organisation of ideas -2 • effective style, orderly sequence, single paragraph structure, formal tone and functional vocabulary Accuracy 1 • Spelling, punctuation and grammar	

	SECTION C – LITERATURE (40 marks)	40 m
6. A	Reference to context	5 m
i	Lomov was of nervous temperament.	1
ii	Lomov's tone when he says "What more do I want?" is uncertain and questioning because he is trying to convince himself that Natalya Stepanovna is a suitable match for him, but at the same time, he seems to be struggling with doubts and fears. His tone suggests that he is trying to reassure himself that he has made the right decision, but he is not entirely convinced.	2
iii	(b) A soliloquy is a speech given by a character alone on stage, which reveals their innermost thoughts and feelings to the audience.	1
iv	Anxiety	1
6. B	Reference to context	5 m
i	[B] Mijbil had escaped and was headed towards the bathroom.	1
ii	Mijbil's interaction with the water tap demonstrates his intelligence and curiosity. His ability to quickly figure out how to turn on the tap shows problem-solving skills and adaptability. This interaction adds depth to the narrative by revealing Mijbil's playful yet clever nature, making him a more engaging and relatable character. It also showcases the author's observation of Mijbil's behaviors, adding a layer of fascination and wonder to the story.	2
iii	To show that Mijbil was able to turn the tap completely, displaying his cleverness.	1
iv	he loved to play with water.	1
7. A.	Reference to context	5 m
i	"Join me".	1
ii	The author uses vivid imagery to convey the tiger's emotions and enhance the mood. The description of the tiger's confinement in a "concrete cell" and its "strength behind bars" evokes a sense of imprisonment and restriction, emphasizing the contrast between physical captivity and the tiger's innate freedom. The imagery of the tiger "stalking the length of his cage" and "ignoring visitors" illustrates frustration and isolation. In contrast, the tiger's gaze at the "brilliant stars" reflects a yearning for freedom and a connection to the vast, unconfined world outside. This contrast between the confined space and the expansive, celestial view underscores the tiger's internal struggle and enhances the overall melancholic and poignant mood of the scene.	2
iii	restless	1

iv	A. hopes to be free and in the wild, someday.	1
7. B	Reference to context	5 m
i	The poet's allusion to divine love in the old man's claim contrasts with the human aspects of love by suggesting that only a divine, unconditional love can truly appreciate someone "for yourself alone." This implies that human love, by contrast, may not be as pure or selfless, often influenced by external factors or conditions. The extract highlights the gap between idealized, divine love and the more conditional nature of human relationships, emphasizing the rarity and profoundness of truly selfless affection.	2
ii	A. 1 and 3 The atmosphere in the lines reflects both devotion and introspection. The old religious man's declaration about divine love suggests a deep reverence (devotion) and provokes contemplation (introspection) about the nature of genuine affection.	1
iii	A. Human love is superficial, and only God's love is pure and unconditional.	1
iv	unconditional love	1
8	Answer ANY FOUR of the following in about 40-50 words each.	4*3=12 m
	Content – • Award 2 marks for 2 valid points and explanation • Award 1 mark for 1 valid point and explanation • No credit of ½ mark Expression – 1 mark when • Answer organized effectively • The language usage needs to display reasons. ½ mark when either is missing Deduct ½ mark from the overall score if the error density is high (more than a total of 2 spellings and/or grammatical errors).	
i	• Lack of Real Friends: Anne felt that she didn't have a true friend with whom she could share her innermost thoughts and feelings. She had acquaintances but no one she could confide in completely. • Desire for Expression: She had a deep need to express herself and share her experiences. Writing in her diary allowed her to freely express her emotions, frustrations, and thoughts without fear of judgment. • Sense of Comfort and Relief: Writing in the diary provided her with comfort and a sense of relief. It became a safe space where she could pour out her heart and feel understood, even if it was just on	3

	paper. Emotional Outlet: During the difficult times of hiding during the war, her diary served as an emotional outlet. It helped her cope with the isolation, fear, and uncertainty she faced daily.	
ii	- Character traits of the postmaster. - He is deeply moved by Lencho's faith which prompts a compassionate response rather than mockery. - He thinks of a plan to maintain Lencho's faith, showing his ability to think outside conventional administrative duties. - His willingness to contribute his own money and to encourage his staff to do the same illustrates a personal commitment to helping others in need. - He respects Lencho's belief system, despite its naivety indicating a high regard for individual faith.	3
iii	Valli's curiosity and independence shape her character in many ways, including: - Planning-Valli is meticulous in planning her bus ride, gathering information about the distance, cost, and time of the trip. - Saving-Valli saves money for the bus ride by resisting the temptation to buy toys, candies, and other things. - Determination-Valli is determined to achieve her dream of taking the bus ride, and she works hard to make it happen. - Confidence-Valli is confident and self-reliant, and she doesn't like being called "Madam" or "Child". - Sacrifice-Valli learns that to achieve something, one has to work hard and make sacrifices. - Life and death-Valli sees a cow run in front of the bus and then finds the same cow dead by the roadside on her return journey. This incident makes her sad and she tries to understand the meaning of life and death.	3
iv	- In the poem "Fog" by Carl Sandburg, personification is used to give the fog human-like qualities, describing it as something that "comes on little cat feet." - This personification creates a vivid image of the fog as a gentle, almost stealthy presence that quietly envelops its surroundings. - By comparing the fog to a cat, the poem evokes a sense of calm and quiet, emphasizing the fog's subtle, mysterious nature. - This contributes to the overall mood of the poem, which is serene	3

	and contemplative, enhancing the imagery of the fog as a soft, almost imperceptible force that moves silently across the landscape.	
v	• Symbolism of Nature: The poet uses elements of nature, such as the hemlock tree and the crow, to symbolize aspects of life that are often considered dark or ominous. Despite their usual negative connotations, these elements lead to a positive outcome for the poet. • Nature's Influence on Mood: The poet reflects on how a simple act of nature—a crow shaking snow off a hemlock tree—can have a profound impact on a person's mood. This small interaction with nature changes the poet's state of mind from gloom to a more uplifted spirit. • Nature's Healing Power: The poem highlights nature's ability to heal and bring about emotional transformation. The light dusting of snow falling on the poet signifies a moment of introspection and a change in perspective, showing how nature can bring comfort and solace. • Attention to Detail: Frost captures a brief, yet vivid moment in nature. His observation of the crow and the falling snow illustrates an appreciation for the small, often overlooked details in the natural world. • Interconnectedness: The poem suggests a connection between human emotions and nature. The interaction with the crow and the snow signifies how nature can influence human experiences, often in unexpected ways. Through these observations, the poet portrays nature as a subtle but powerful force capable of altering one's emotions and perspective.	3
9	Answer ANY TWO of the following in about 40-50 words each.	2*3=6
	Content – • Award 2 marks for 2 valid points and explanation • Award 1 mark for 1 valid point and explanation • No credit of ½ mark Expression – 1 mark when • Answer organised effectively • The language usage needs to display reasons. ½ mark when either is missing Deduct ½ mark from the overall score if the error density is high (more than a total of 2 spellings and/or grammatical errors).	
i	• Emotional Attachment: Mrs. Pumphrey was extremely attached to Tricki, treating him more like a child than a pet. She indulged him with excessive care, attention, and luxuries, showing how deeply she cared for him. • Overindulgence: Her overindulgence in feeding Tricki rich foods	3

	and pampering him with unnecessary comforts indicates her inability to deny him anything, which stems from her profound affection and attachment. • Worry and Anxiety: When Dr. Herriot suggested taking Tricki to the clinic, Mrs. Pumphrey was filled with worry and anxiety. She was concerned about how Tricki would cope without her constant presence and care, indicating how difficult the separation was for her. • Preparation for Separation: Mrs. Pumphrey sent Tricki off with a collection of his favorite toys, cushions, and food, showing her reluctance to part with him and her desire to make sure he was as comfortable as possible in her absence. • Frequent Inquiries: During Tricki's stay at the clinic, Mrs. Pumphrey constantly inquired about his well-being. She sent daily updates and requests, showing her inability to detach herself from him even for a short period. • Emotional Reaction: When Tricki was finally returned to her, Mrs. Pumphrey's overwhelming joy and relief demonstrated how much she missed him, further proving how hard it was for her to be separated from her beloved pet. These points highlight Mrs. Pumphrey's deep emotional bond with Tricki and how challenging it was for her to part with him.	
ii	• Clever Deception: Ausable uses quick thinking to concoct a story about a balcony outside the window. He describes it convincingly, suggesting that it's a way to escape if needed. This creates a sense of urgency and fear in Max. • Calm Demeanor: Ausable maintains a calm and confident demeanor while describing the balcony, which makes his lie more believable. By acting as if the balcony is a known fact, he gives the impression that he has already planned an escape route. • Manipulation of the Environment: Max stands near the window and implies that it's an easy access point to the balcony. He uses the darkness outside the window to his advantage, making it impossible for Ausable to verify the existence of the balcony. • Psychological Pressure: By threatening to shoot if anyone interferes, Max increases the psychological pressure on Ausable and the others, forcing them to act quickly and	3

	believe his story without question. • Preying on Panic: Max exploits the element of surprise and panic. The unexpected appearance of the "police" at the door makes the balcony seem like a logical and necessary escape route, which further convinces everyone in the room of its existence. Through these tactics, Ausable successfully deceives others into believing there is a balcony attached to the room, even though there isn't one.	
iii	In the line "And in her smiling eyes was the light of a deep satisfaction that an artist feels when contemplating the completion of her masterpiece" from the story "Bholi," the "artist" refers to Bholi's teacher, and the "masterpiece" is Bholi herself. Here's the elaboration: • Bholi's Transformation: Bholi starts as a shy, insecure girl who is ridiculed and overlooked because of her speech impediment and perceived lack of intelligence. Her transformation into a confident and assertive individual is the result of her education and the encouragement she receives from her teacher. • The Teacher as the Artist: The teacher plays a crucial role in Bholi's development, much like an artist shaping a piece of art. She patiently teaches Bholi, nurtures her self-esteem, and empowers her to believe in herself. Her efforts help Bholi find her voice and gain the confidence to stand up for herself. • Education as the Medium: The teacher uses education as her medium to mold Bholi, similar to how an artist uses paint and brushes to create a masterpiece. Through her guidance, the teacher instills knowledge and self-worth in Bholi, transforming her from a timid child into a strong and independent woman. • The Masterpiece Completed: Bholi's act of rejecting an unfair marriage proposal symbolizes the completion of her transformation. This moment is like the final stroke of the artist's brush, marking the successful culmination of Bholi's journey from a fearful girl to an empowered individual. • Teacher's Satisfaction: The deep satisfaction in the teacher's eyes is akin to the joy an artist feels when looking at a finished work of art. It's the fulfillment that comes from knowing she has made a meaningful impact on Bholi's life, helping her become the best version of herself. Through this metaphor, the story highlights the profound influence a teacher can have on a student's life, much like an artist creating a masterpiece, showcasing the transformative power of education and guidance.	3
10	Answer ANY ONE of the following in about 100-120 words.	1*6=6

	Content 3 Expression 2 Accuracy 1	
i	In "The Tale of Custard the Dragon," Ogden Nash uses a whimsical tale to illustrate themes of bravery through Custard, who overcomes his fears to protect his friends. The playful, fantastical setting underscores the idea that true courage can arise unexpectedly, regardless of one's initial appearance or reputation. In contrast, Joyce Kilmer's "Trees" employs the imagery of trees to symbolize strength and beauty. The poem's appreciation of the tree's enduring and nurturing qualities can also be seen as a metaphor for the freedom and empowerment of women. By celebrating the tree's natural grace and resilience, Kilmer reflects on the strength and independence that women can embody. The tree's steadfastness and vitality parallel the evolving role of women in society, highlighting their capacity for growth, resilience, and autonomy. Thus, while "The Tale of Custard the Dragon" uses a fantastical narrative to convey courage, "Trees" uses natural imagery to symbolically support the theme of women's freedom and empowerment.	6
ii	Both "The Sermon at Benares" and "His First Flight" address the theme of overcoming obstacles and achieving self-realization through distinct yet complementary narratives. In "The Sermon at Benares," the Buddha's teachings emphasize overcoming ignorance and attachment as the path to enlightenment. The story illustrates how enlightenment is achieved through understanding and transcending personal desires and fears, focusing on inner transformation and moral development as essential steps toward spiritual awakening. Similarly, in "His First Flight," the young seagull faces the challenge of overcoming his fear of flying to achieve his first successful flight. This story highlights the struggle between comfort and the courage required to take risks and embrace new experiences. The seagull's journey symbolizes personal growth and self-discovery, achieved by confronting and overcoming his fears. Both texts share the theme of personal growth through overcoming internal and external challenges. They depict the journey from fear and ignorance to realization and accomplishment, illustrating that self-improvement involves confronting and surmounting one's limitations.	6
11	Answer ANY ONE of the following in about 100-120 words.	1*6=6
	Content 3 Expression 2 Accuracy 1	
i	Mme Loisel's character in "The Necklace" is significantly shaped by her pursuit of material wealth, the resulting hardships, and her interactions with society.	6

	Her desire for luxury and social status drives her dissatisfaction with her modest life. This ambition leads her to borrow a necklace to appear wealthier than she is at a high-society event, showcasing her yearning for materialism and recognition. This pursuit of superficial status, however, results in severe consequences. After losing the necklace, she and her husband endure years of poverty and hard labor to repay the debt, reflecting the harsh repercussions of her initial choice. Mme Loisel's interactions with society further illustrate her character development. Initially, she is discontent with her place in life and longs for a higher social standing. However, after the hardships caused by the loss of the necklace, her perspective shifts. The story's twist reveals that the necklace was a fake, highlighting the futility of her material aspirations and the superficial nature of social status. Thus, Mme Loisel's character is shaped by her material desires, the unintended consequences of her actions, and the societal expectations she struggles with.	
ii	Horace Danby's character in "A Question of Trust" reveals the nuanced interplay between criminal intent and personal morality through his dual nature. Danby is depicted as a meticulous and skilled thief who commits crimes to support his seemingly respectable life. His character exhibits a complex blend of criminal intent and personal morality; despite his criminal activities, he is portrayed as an individual with a clear sense of right and wrong in his personal life. His attempt to rob a safe while posing as an upstanding member of society reflects his inner conflict between his criminal behavior and his desire to maintain a veneer of respectability. The twist in the story, where he is deceived by the seemingly innocent woman, underscores the theme of trust and deception. Danby's interactions reveal how one's appearance and actions can mask deeper moral contradictions. Ultimately, the story suggests that trust is inherently fragile and can be easily manipulated, exposing the intricate relationship between one's public persona and private actions.	6